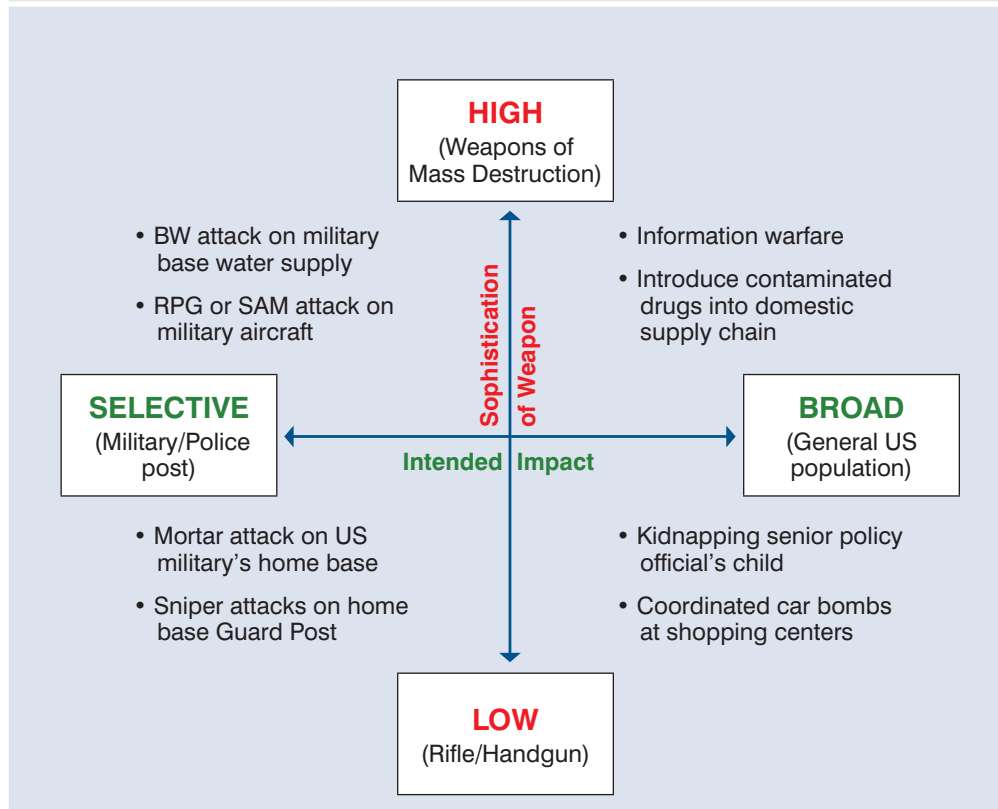


Hypothetical Threats to the Homeland: Using Spectrums to Define Potential Targets



A Futures Exercise. The graphic captures four potential futures to understand how foreign insurgents might carry out an attack on the United States. A brainstorming exercise helped analysts identify two key uncertainties (the sophistication of weapons used by the insurgents and the intended impact of the attack) and arrayed these factors on a graph as the “x” and “y” axes. The four resulting quadrants in the 2 x 2 matrix allowed analysts to visualize potential targets from the various combinations (low to high sophistication of weapons and selective to broad intended impact of an attack). For example, if a group possessed highly sophisticated weapons and intended a broad attack on the United States, potential targets could include computer networks and domestic drug supplies. Having filled in a quadrant, analysts can then turn to devising likely indicators or signposts of such a future.